

A PAPER-PROTOTYPE DEMO KIT

BROKEN GRIMOIRE

You are a wizard who fell into a dungeon and woke up to find your grimoire torn into fragments.
Escape the dungeon, and find out who tore it apart.

WHAT'S IN THIS KIT

Pages 2–4	How to Play, Crafting & Spells, Quick Reference + HP/Mana trackers
Page 5	Special enemies — the Warden's charge and the boss room (Wards, Scraps, Erasure)
Pages 6–7	11 spell-fragment cards — your starting deck
Page 8	Loot — 6 fragment cards enemies drop, plus the heal potion
Page 9	8 enemy reference cards — stats, actions, attack patterns, drops
Page 10	Token sheet — player/enemy tokens, HP & mana pips, Burn/Root/Stun markers
Page 11	Shape templates — cut-out overlays for Beam, Cross, and their doubled forms
Pages 12–14	3 room boards — The Cistern, The Scriptorium, The Redactor

GATHER BEFORE YOU PLAY

- Scissors (to cut out the fragment, loot and enemy cards, the token sheet, and the shape templates)
- The token sheet (page 10) — player, enemy, HP/Mana and status tokens (coins or dice work too if you'd rather not cut)
- One person to run the monsters ("the GM") — can rotate every room
- For the boss room: the Erasure Zone templates, Erasure stack counters and the Warden's charge marker from the separate A4 print-and-cut kit (a coin and a sticky note work too)

How to Play

OBJECTIVE

Clear all 3 rooms. Reach the exit of the final room to win the demo.

SETUP

Place Room 1 (The Cistern) on the table. Put the player token on its marked start tile and set HP to 20 and mana to 3 on the trackers (p.4). Shuffle the 11 fragment cards into a deck and draw a hand of 5. Place enemy tokens on their marked tiles, using the enemy reference cards for their stats. Set the loot cards and heal potion (p.8) aside.

TURNS

The game is turn based and goes round robin: you take your turn, then each enemy takes its own turn in number order (lowest first; two of the same number — the one in the lower-numbered row goes first). When everyone has gone, a new round starts. On its turn, every character spends the actions shown on its card, one at a time. No unit can move through or onto a tile with another unit or a pillar. At the start of your turn, draw back up to 5 cards — unplayed cards stay in your hand. When the deck runs out, shuffle the discard pile into a new deck.

1. Your turn — 3 actions, in any order:

- **Move** — 1 tile up, down, left or right (no diagonals).
- **Cast** — 1 action + the combo's mana cost. Combining 2–3 fragments from your hand is the cast: it resolves immediately (see Crafting & Spells).
- **Meditate** — 1 action, +3 mana. Doesn't end your turn early — you can meditate twice and still cast something with your third action.
- **Reroll** — 1 action: discard your whole hand and draw 5 fresh.
- **Drink potion** — 1 action, +10 HP (max 20), if you're carrying one.

2. Enemy turns:

Each enemy spends its ACTIONS one at a time: an action is either a 1-tile move (no diagonals) or an attack on a target inside its attack pattern — at most one attack per turn (The Redactor is the exception, p.5). Default behaviour: take the shortest path toward you until you're in range, then attack. Special rules printed on an enemy's card override this.

WINNING & LEAVING A ROOM

Every enemy you kill drops the card listed on its reference card — take it from the loot pile (p.8) and add it to your discard pile. The Warden drops the heal potion. Some rooms have an exit that's open the whole time: you may walk onto it and move to the next room whenever you choose, even with enemies still alive, but you forfeit their fragments. Other rooms lock the exit behind a crowned enemy — kill it to unlock. Your HP carries over into the next room; your mana resets to 3.

LOSING

You lose if your HP reaches 0, or if your hand, deck and discard pile together no longer hold at least one element and one shape (or three Fire cards). Cards carried by Page Scraps and erased cards don't count — you need a spell to win them back (p.5).

Crafting & Spells

HOW TO CRAFT

Take 2–3 fragment cards from your hand and combine them — this is your Cast action (1 action + mana). The combo resolves immediately — pick a target tile and it casts right away (skip this for a self-centered shape like Cross or Unstable Fire); there's no such thing as an assembled spell waiting in your hand. The fragments you used go to the discard pile. You refill to 5 at the start of your next turn. Order never matters: Fire + Beam and Beam + Fire are the same card.

COST

Cost = number of fragments used, +1 for every *doubled* element or shape (using two Fire cards, or two Beam cards, in the same combo). A normal 2-fragment combo costs 2 mana; a doubled 3-fragment combo costs 4.

UNSTABLE FIRE (Fire + Fire + Fire)

Stacking three Fire cards together — with no shape card — triggers a special result instead of the normal stacking bonus: a 3×3 burst centered on *you*, dealing 7 damage to everything in it. You Burn yourself as the cost (1 dmg at the start of each of your next 3 turns), and it costs 5 of your 6 mana. Usable once per fight.

WHAT CAN BE COMBINED

Every combo needs exactly one element and one shape, and either can be doubled (Fire + Fire + Beam, Water + Cross + Cross). No mixing for now: Fire + Water + Beam or Rock + Beam + Cross can't be cast, and neither can elements with no shape. The one exception is Unstable Fire (Fire + Fire + Fire, above).

Quick Reference

Fragments used, +1 per doubled element or shape. Minimum cast is 2 fragments.

-  **BURN (Fire)** — The target takes 1 dmg at the start of each of its next 3 turns — whether or not it acts.
-  **ROOT (Water)** — Target can't move during its whole next turn (it can still attack if already in range).
-  **STUN (Rock)** — Target can't attack during its whole next turn (it can still move). Also cancels a charged Warden slash.
-  **IMMUNE** — An immune unit ignores both damage and status effects.

- BEAM** — Line, 2 tiles ahead of the caster. Doubled: 4 tiles.
- CROSS** — The 4 tiles adjacent to you, not your own tile. Doubled: reaches 2 tiles out each way (8 tiles).

- **YOU** — Player start tile
- **EXIT** — Open exit — walk on to advance, forfeiting any live enemies' fragments
- **EXIT (locked)** — Exit is sealed until the crowned enemy in the room dies
- **PIL** — Pillar — blocks line of sight for ranged attacks
- **circle + number** — An enemy — match the number to its reference card

HP (start at 20 — carries over between rooms)
Cross off boxes left → right as you take damage.

MANA (cap 6 — refills to 3 at the start of each room)
Fill boxes left → right; empty them to pay for spells.

5

Special Enemies

THE WARDEN'S HALBERD (Room 2)

The Warden sees along every straight and diagonal line from its tile, like a queen in chess. On its turn it moves until you're on one of those lines. As soon as it sees you, it spends 1 action **charging** — this ends its turn. Point the charge marker at you.

On its next turn, its first action is the **slash**: a 5-damage wave along the charged line. The wave has no length limit — it passes through other monsters and stops at you, a pillar or a wall. If you've stepped off that line, it misses. A **Stun** cancels the charge.

PAGE WARDS & PAGE SCRAPS (Room 3)

Each Page Ward has 1 action: **summon** one Page Scrap on a free tile next to it, then rest for one round. A new Scrap starts moving the round after it appears. Scraps have 4 actions and follow the first rule that applies:

- **Carrying a card it hasn't fed yet:** walk to The Redactor and spend 1 action to **feed** — The Redactor gains +1 Erasure stack (max 5). Then flee. The Scrap keeps the card: The Redactor feeds on the knowledge, not the page.
- **Carrying a fed card:** flee from you.
- **Empty-handed:** walk to you and **steal** (1 action) — take a random fragment from your hand and put it under the Scrap. Empty hand: nothing to steal.
- **Stacks at 5:** no more stealing — every Scrap flees and waits.
- **All Wards down:** Scraps stop fleeing and stealing. They move onto the free tiles next to you — the ones outside an Erasure Zone first — to trap you.
- Kill a Scrap that carries a card and the card goes back into your hand (the stack stays).

THE REDACTOR — ACTIONS 2 → 4 → 3

- **While any Ward stands:** 2 actions, and it may attack with both. Immune to damage and status effects.
- **Chaos mode** (all Wards gone): one chaos turn per Erasure stack (max 5), each with **4 actions**. After an attack, its next action can't be an attack (it can still move), so it attacks at most twice. Each attack deals 3 dmg to the 8 tiles around it and leaves a **3×3 Erasure Zone** — its own tile plus those 8 (use the template). A zone disappears when you finish your next turn. Remove a stack at the end of each chaos turn. Stun cancels its attacks that turn (the stack is still removed).
- **Stacks gone** (or none when the last Ward fell): 3 actions and one attack, no zones.

ERASURE

If you end your turn inside an Erasure Zone, one **random** fragment from your hand is **erased** — it leaves the game, not the discard pile. With an empty hand, erase the top card of your deck instead.

If your hand, deck and discard pile no longer hold an element and a shape, you lose. In the full game, you get every erased fragment back when you defeat the boss.

Spell Fragments (1 of 2)

Pattern key (Beam, Cross): solid = base cast, hatched = doubled-only reach, marked square = you.

ELEMENT

FIRE

1 DMG. Burn: the target takes 1 dmG at the start of each of its next 3 turns.

Doubled: +2 dmG. Three Fires: Unstable Fire (see p.3).

×3 IN DECK

ELEMENT

FIRE

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Doubled: +2 dmG. Three Fires: Unstable Fire (see p.3).

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ELEMENT

FIRE

1 DMG. Burn: the target takes 1 dmG at the start of each of its next 3 turns.

Doubled: +2 dmG. Three Fires: Unstable Fire (see p.3).

×3 IN DECK

ELEMENT

WATER

2 DMG. Root: target can't move during its whole next turn (it can still attack if in range).

Doubled: +2 dmG.

×2 IN DECK

ELEMENT

WATER

2 DMG. Root: target can't move during its whole next turn (it can still attack if in range).

Doubled: +2 dmG.

×2 IN DECK

ELEMENT

ROCK

2 DMG. Stun: target can't attack during its whole next turn (it can still move).

Doubled: +2 dmG.

×2 IN DECK

Spell Fragments (2 of 2)

Pattern key (Beam, Cross): solid = base cast, hatched = doubled-only reach, marked square = you.

ELEMENT

ROCK

2 DMG. Stun: target can't attack during its whole next turn (it can still move).

Doubled: +2 dmg.

×2 IN DECK

APPEARANCE

BEAM

Shape: a line, 2 tiles ahead of the caster.



Doubled: 4-tile line.

×2 IN DECK

APPEARANCE

BEAM

Shape: a line, 2 tiles ahead of the caster.



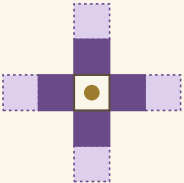
Doubled: 4-tile line.

×2 IN DECK

APPEARANCE

CROSS

Shape: the 4 tiles around you, not your own tile.



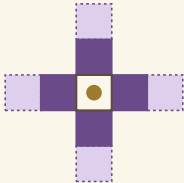
Doubled: reaches 2 tiles out each way (8 tiles).

×2 IN DECK

APPEARANCE

CROSS

Shape: the 4 tiles around you, not your own tile.



Doubled: reaches 2 tiles out each way (8 tiles).

×2 IN DECK

Loot — Enemy Drops

Keep these out of the starting deck. When you kill an enemy, take the card its reference card lists and add it to your discard pile. Skip an enemy and its drop is lost.

ELEMENT
ROCK

2 DMG. Stun: target can't attack during its whole next turn (it can still move).

Doubled: +2 dmg.

LOOT · BRUTE DROP

ELEMENT
ROCK

2 DMG. Stun: target can't attack during its whole next turn (it can still move).

Doubled: +2 dmg.

LOOT · BRUTE DROP

ELEMENT
FIRE

1 DMG. Burn: the target takes 1 dmg at the start of each of its next 3 turns.

Doubled: +2 dmg. Three Fires: Unstable Fire (see p.3).

LOOT · RAT DROP

APPEARANCE
BEAM

Shape: a line, 2 tiles ahead of the caster.



Doubled: 4-tile line.

LOOT · ARCHER DROP

APPEARANCE
BEAM

Shape: a line, 2 tiles ahead of the caster.



Doubled: 4-tile line.

LOOT · ARCHER DROP

ELEMENT
WATER

2 DMG. Root: target can't move during its whole next turn (it can still attack if in range).

Doubled: +2 dmg.

LOOT · LEECH DROP

ITEM
HEAL POTION

Drink: 1 action, +10 HP (max 20).
Keep it until you need it — it carries into later rooms, including the boss room.

LOOT · WARDEN DROP

Enemy Reference Cards

Icon key: marked square = the enemy. Solid = the tile its attack hits; faded = other directions it could pick instead (one target only). Arrowheads = the attack keeps going until it hits something. The Redactor's sweep hits all 8 solid tiles at once. Movement is up/down/left/right only.

1. RAT

HP 2 ACTIONS 3

ATTACK 1 dmg to one adjacent tile.

Moves in packs — punishes single-target spells.



DROPS Fire fragment

2. ARCHER

HP 3 ACTIONS 2

ATTACK 2 dmg, range 4, in a straight or diagonal line. Blocked by pillars.

If you're adjacent when its turn starts, it spends both actions backing off 2 tiles.



DROPS Beam fragment

3. BRUTE

HP 6 ACTIONS 2

ATTACK 3 dmg to one adjacent tile.

Slow but tough — a tempo check, not a puzzle.



DROPS Rock fragment

4. LEECH

HP 4 ACTIONS 2

ATTACK Drains 1 mana (not HP) from one adjacent tile.

Pressures your meditation, not your HP.



DROPS Water fragment

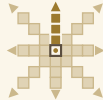
5. WARDEN

HP 8 ACTIONS 2

ATTACK Halberd wave: 5 dmg down a straight or diagonal line, any length. Passes through monsters; stops at you, a pillar or a wall.

Crowned. Moves until you're in its line, then spends 1 action charging — that ends its turn (point the charge marker at you). Next turn it slashes down that line. Step off to dodge; Stun cancels the charge. See p.5.

DROPS Heal potion (+ unlocks the exit)



6. PAGE WARD

×3, boss room

HP 4 ACTIONS 1

ATTACK None — does not attack.

Only spells with its element (Fire / Water / Rock) hurt it. Action: summon 1 Page Scrap next to it, then rest for one round.

DROPS Nothing

7. PAGE SCRAP

boss room

HP 1 ACTIONS 4

ATTACK Steal (1 action): a random fragment from your hand goes under the Scrap.

Wards up: steal, walk to The Redactor, feed (1 action, +1 stack), flee — keeping the card. Stacks at 5: all flee. Wards down: they trap you. See p.5.

DROPS The card it carries



8. THE REDACTOR

BOSS

HP 18 ACTIONS 2 / 4 / 3

ATTACK 3 dmg to all 8 tiles around it. Chaos: each attack leaves a 3×3 Erasure Zone.

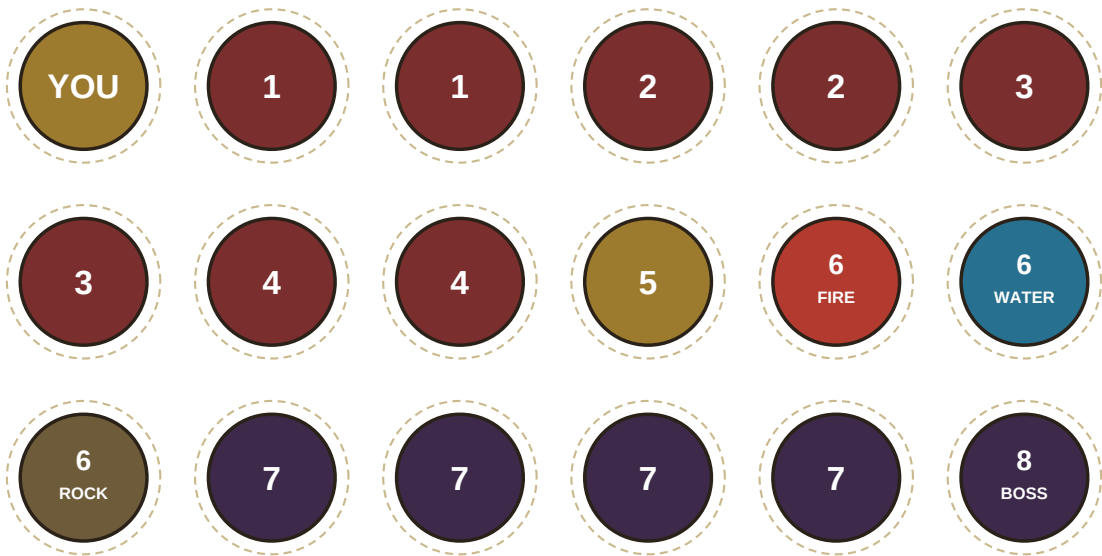
Wards up: 2 actions, may attack twice; immune. Wards down: 1 chaos turn per stack (max 5), 4 actions, no attacks back to back. Stacks gone: 3 actions, 1 attack.

DROPS Nothing — beat it to win



Player & Enemy Tokens

Cut along the dashed circles. Numbers match the Enemy Reference Cards (p.9); colors match the room boards. No scissors handy? Coins, dice, or scraps of paper marked with the same numbers work just as well.



WHAT'S ON THE SHEET

- YOU x1 — Player
- 2 x2 — Archer
- 4 x2 — Leech
- 6-FIRE / 6-WATER / 6-ROCK x1 each — Page Ward (Boss room)
- 8-BOSS x1 — The Redactor

●

 1 x2 — Rat

●

 3 x2 — Brute

●

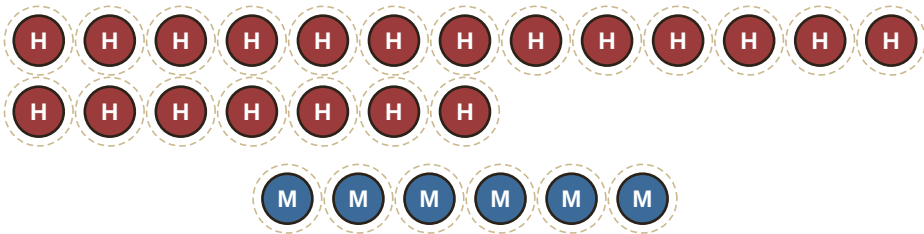
 5 x1 — Warden — crowned (Room 2)

●

 7 x4 — Page Scrap — Wards summon these; keep spares handy

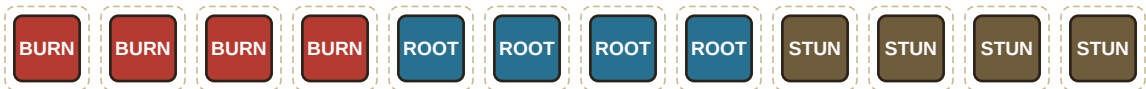
HP & MANA TOKENS

Optional stand-ins for the HP/Mana checkbox tracks (Quick Reference, p.4) — place one per box lost or spent instead of crossing it off, remove it if you heal or regain the resource. HP x20, Mana x6.



STATUS TOKENS

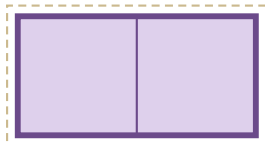
Drop one on a unit's token to mark Burn, Root, or Stun (see Quick Reference, p.4). Remove it once the effect ends.



Shape Templates

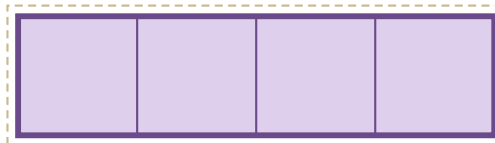
Cut along the outer edge of each shaded shape. Lay a template on the board when you cast a shaped spell to see exactly which tiles it hits, resolve the effect, then lift it off. Sized to the 0.62" grid in Rooms 1–2; Room 3's grid is smaller (0.55", to fit its 8×8 size on the page) so templates overhang a little there — count tiles by hand if it matters.

BEAM



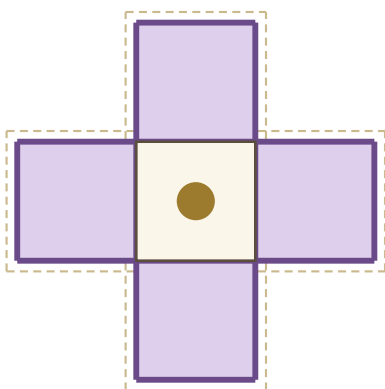
Base — 2 tiles. Place the near edge at your tile; it points the way you cast.

BEAM (DOUBLED)



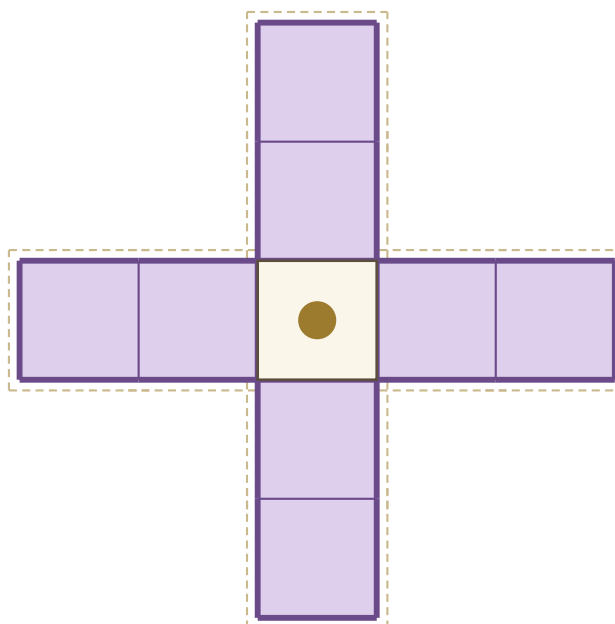
Two Beam cards — 4 tiles, same direction.

CROSS



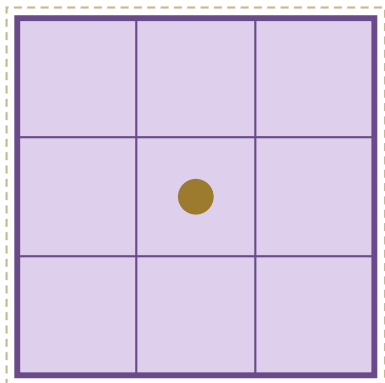
Base — the 4 tiles around you. The marked square is you; it isn't hit.

CROSS (DOUBLED)



Two Cross cards — reaches 2 tiles out each way.

UNSTABLE FIRE



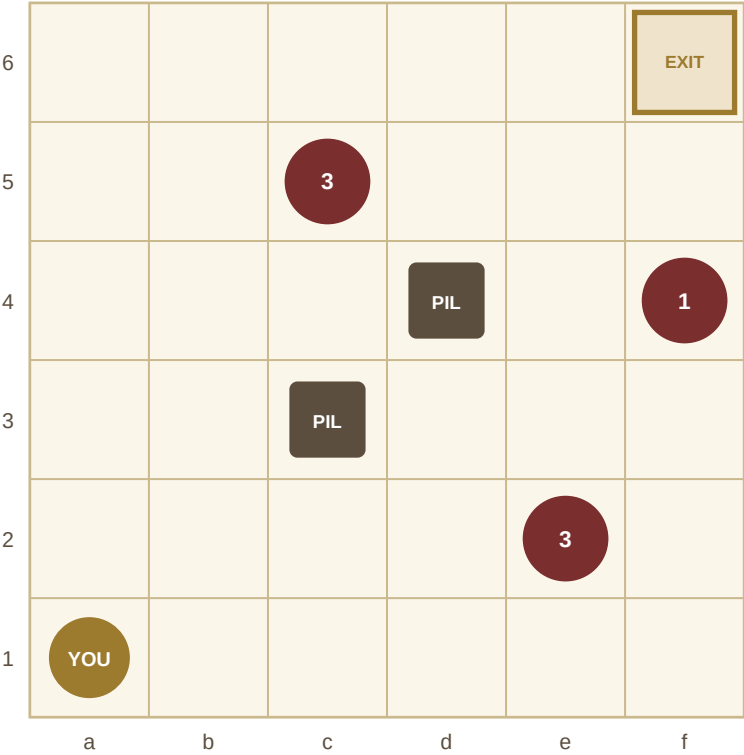
3×3, centered on the gold dot — that's you.

Fire + Fire + Fire, once per fight (p.3) — gets its own template since it's a full 3×3 block, not a +, and it only ever centers on yourself.

Tip: if a template hangs off the edge of the board, the tiles that fall off the grid simply aren't hit.

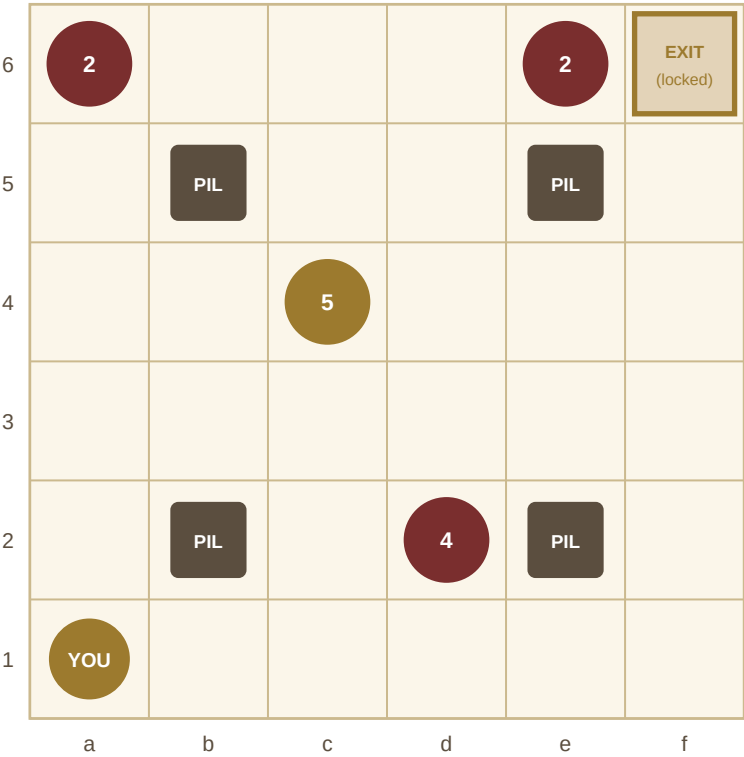
The Cistern

Teaching room. The exit is open the whole time — you may leave as soon as you want, but every enemy you skip is a fragment you don't get. Target: clear it in 3–4 of your turns.



The Scriptorium

The exit is locked until the crowned Warden dies.



The Redactor

Defeat the boss to finish the demo. While any Page Ward stands, the boss takes no damage — each Ward only takes damage from its own attuned element. Wards summon Page Scraps every other round.

